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UAE STANDS FIRM: IRANIAN MISSILE ATTACKS FOILED, CALM PREVAILS

■ COUNTRY'S MEASURED RESPONSE REINFORCES PUBLIC CONFIDENCE

■ AUTHORITIES QUICKLY ACTIVATE NATIONWIDE EMERGENCY PROTOCOLS

■ GLOBAL SOLIDARITY WITH THE UAE, CONDEMNING IRANIAN MISSILE STRIKES

DUBAI
BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Managing Editor

The UAE displayed composure, precision, and national unity as it intercepted a massive missile and drone assault launched from Iran, demonstrating readiness and resilience in the face of one of the most severe regional escalations in recent history.

The UAE Ministry of Defence confirmed that 165 ballistic missiles, 2 cruise missiles and 541 drones fired from Iran were detected approaching UAE territory. Of these, 152 ballistic missiles were destroyed, while 13 of them fell into the sea. Both cruise missiles were also detected and destroyed, and 506 drones were intercepted and destroyed, while 35 of them fell inside the country's territory, causing material damage, and resulting in 3 deaths and 58 injuries.

Debris landed in parts of Abu Dhabi and Dubai. Minor fires including one on the outer façade of Burj Al Arab and on Dubai Palm, were swiftly controlled. Emergency teams at Dubai International Airport managed minor damage and ensured passenger safety under pre-established contingency plans.



Residents go about their daily routine in Sharjah yesterday.

Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

Regional escalation

The Iranian missile assault on the UAE occurred less than 24 hours after the launch of joint attack named Operation Roaring Lion by Israel and Operation Epic Fury by the United States, which targeted military infrastructure across Iran. Reports confirm these strikes killed Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei and several top military commanders, plunging the Islamic Republic into unprecedented internal chaos and triggering retaliatory attacks on Gulf states. The UAE, along with

other Gulf nations, was quickly targeted as part of Iran's response to the US-Israel operations.

Despite the scale of the attacks and the broader chaos following the US-Israel strikes on Iran, UAE operations and civil order remained intact. From air defence interceptions to coordinated public communications and emergency management, the nation's calm and measured response reinforced public confidence. Authorities reaffirmed that safety of citizens, residents, and visitors is the top priority,

and called for unity, caution, and reliance on official sources.

Swift national response

Within minutes of detecting the incoming threats, UAE authorities activated nationwide emergency protocols including partial airspace closures and suspension of flights; distance learning for all schools and universities (March 2–4); deployment of emergency teams to affected areas; protection of key infrastructure, including airports, ports, and civilian buildings.

UNDER CONTROL

The National Emergency Crisis and Disaster Management Authority confirmed the situation remains under control, with round-the-clock monitoring and a fully integrated national response. Approximately 20,200 affected passengers were provided meals, accommodation, and rebooking support, all at state expense. Supply chains remained fully operational, and strategic reserves were unaffected, prompting authorities to warn against panic buying.

escalation had been anticipated for months, noting that Gulf states had made every effort to avoid confrontation. "There is no alternative to political dialogue. Military responses only deepen crises and escalate instability," he said, also highlighted that Iran's attacks had missed their intended targets while further isolating the country diplomatically.

Defence system

Minister of State for International Cooperation Reem Al Hashimy confirmed the UAE's defence systems are among the most advanced globally and fully operational. She emphasised that while the UAE is prepared to defend itself, measured responses and calm remain essential to prevent wider escalation.

Addressing misinformation

The UAE authorities also took decisive steps to counter misinformation. The UAE Public Prosecution warned that sharing false or unverified content could result in legal consequences.

The Ministry of Defence described the attacks as a serious escalation, a violation of UAE sovereignty, and a breach of international law. It reaffirmed the nation's right to defend its territory, people, and national interests.

SEE ALSO P2-11

Khamenei's killing plunges Iran into uncertainty

Trump vows 'heavy bombing' would continue as long as necessary

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Iranian Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei was killed in a major US-Israeli assault on Iran, plunging the Islamic Republic into uncertainty and heightening fears of wider regional instability.

Iranian state television and the IRNA news agency confirmed the 86-year-old's death early yesterday. US President Donald Trump said the development gave Iranians their "greatest chance" to "take back" their country and vowed that "heavy and pinpoint bombing" would continue as long as necessary.

The joint US-Israeli operation targeted Iranian military and government sites. Israel pressed ahead with additional strikes, including a massive blast that rocked central Tehran. The Israeli military said it was striking the "heart" of the capital after clearing a path to



AFP

■ People mourn the death of Ayatollah Ali Khamenei in Tehran yesterday.

the city a day earlier. Iran retaliated by firing drones and missiles at Israel and at US military installations across the Gulf. The Revolutionary Guard warned it would launch its "most intense offensive operation" yet, targeting Israel and American bases.

As the region braced for escalation, world leaders urged restraint and a return to diplomacy, even as Tehran vowed devastating retaliation following the killing of its long-time leader. A massive explosion rocked the Iranian capital yesterday morning as the Israeli military said it was targeting the "heart" of the city after stating it cleared the path to Tehran the day before.



IFTAR 18:25

Fajr 05:24 Shuruq 06:38
Dhuhr 12:34 Asr 15:53
Maghrib 18:25 Isha 19:38

IMSAK 05:14

Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah



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